

Communication Skills

Quiz 1 / Mid-sem study guide

Course LA10760 · Dr. Srirupa Chatterjee · summarised from lectures L2-L8 plus the writing lecture notes

What the last slide says about the quiz

- **Multiple-choice questions, no negative marking** (so never leave one blank).
- Questions come from the **general content of the lectures delivered in class**.
- **No specific questions from the short stories** (Civil Peace, The Fly). Their plot and style still matter as examples of lecture ideas.
- There will also be **comprehension passages with questions**.
- Mode: hard copy, answered in the classroom (the slide says LHC-4), 12:00 to 1:00 pm.

The slide text reads "Sept 19, 2025, Friday". That looks like last year's date carried over, so check your real date and venue with the course announcement.

How to use this guide

- **Page 2** is the one-page cheat sheet: read it last thing tonight and again tomorrow.
- **Sections 1-9** follow the lectures in order. Diagrams are redrawn from the slides so you can see the shapes (plot types, argument outline, Burkean parlor).
- **Section 10** has quick tips for comprehension passages (these are general tips, not from the slides).
- **Section 11** is a 50-question MCQ drill with an answer key. Do it cold, then re-read whatever you missed.

#	Section	Source
1	Communication and idea generation	L2
2	Achebe, Nigeria and African storytelling	L2, L3
3	Plot: literature and communication	L3
4	Modernism, modern art and Camus	L4
5	The two stories at a glance	L3, L5
6	Arguments and scholarly communication	L6
7	Writing an essay: templates and style manuals	L7
8	Writing well: final points (tense, parallelism, passive voice)	L8
9	Writing rules, AI ethics, plagiarism	Lecture notes
10	Comprehension-passage tips	General
11	Practice MCQs and answer key	Drill



One-page cheat sheet

Memorise these lists and dates

Communication process

- Sender → Encoded message → Receiver → Decoded message
- Communication is not merely conveying information; it is often **socially negotiated problem solving**
- Brainstorming: intuitive, collaborative, many perspectives, leads to evaluation and organisation

Aristotle's 5 common topics

- **Definition** (genus/division)
- **Comparison** (similarity/difference/degree)
- **Relationship** (cause/effect, antecedent/consequence, contraries/contradictions)
- **Circumstance** (possible/impossible, past fact/future fact)
- **Testimony** (authority, testimonials, statistics, maxims, law, precedents, examples)

5 plot types

- **Linear**: Freytag's pyramid
- **Circular**: Hero's Journey (*Ramayana, Prodigal Son*)
- **Non-linear**: many epics, contemporary plots
- **Open-ended**: end has infinite possibilities, no resolution
- **Interactive**: modern theatre, breaking the fourth wall
- Freytag: exposition → rising action → climax → falling action → resolution/catastrophe

Choosing a plot

- Your role and audience expectations
- Audience's requirements
- Channels of communication
- End goal

Writing mistakes (notes + L8)

- Tense discontinuity: keep one main tense; shift only to mark a real change in time
- Passive voice: subject is acted upon; prefer active. Passive is fine when the actor is unknown, irrelevant, to be left vague, or for a general truth
- **Parallel structure**: pairs and lists follow the same grammatical pattern
- Subject-verb agreement; consistent pronouns (person and number)
- Modifier errors; wordiness; incomplete sentences; too many ideas in one sentence
- Gender-inclusive language; avoid abbreviations (&, etc., e.g.)
- **Readerly writing**: simple and precise, grammatical, chronological, no contradictions, no complexity

Modernism

- Precursors: **Marx** (Materialism), **Freud** (Unconscious), **Darwin** (Evolution)
- Western movement, late 19th to early 20th c. (1900-1920s)
- Rebellion against traditional values; questions all-powerful God and moral codes
- Art: Cubism (Picasso), **Dada** = 'nonsense' (Duchamp), Surrealism (Breton, Paris)
- Camus, *The Myth of Sisyphus* (1942): the **absurd**; absurd hero

Arguments

- Keywords: **5-7**
- Thesis / topic sentence: **25-30 words**
- Outline: thesis first; major points **I, II, III**; supporting **A, B, C**; then **1, 2, 3**; then **a, b, c**
- Formal disagreement: use facts and evidence; no personal attacks; humour only to defuse, never to mock

Burkean parlor

- Kenneth Burke, *The Philosophy of Literary Form* (1941)
- You arrive late to a discussion already going; you listen, join in, leave, and it continues
- = scholarly communication across generations; accurate recording of data is key; we fill gaps in existing scholarship

Astronomy chain

- Aristotle (384-322 BC): Earth at centre
- Ptolemy (100-170 AD): **geocentric**
- Copernicus (1473-1543): **heliocentric**, round orbits
- Galileo (1564-1642)
- Kepler (1571-1630): elliptical orbits
- Newton: a century later

Essay skeleton (They Say, I Say)

- Intro: begin with a debate, state your position, refer to critical sources
- Body positions: disagree / agree + add / agree and disagree / undecided
- Conclusion transitions: as a result, after all, in short, finally, to summarize, in sum, simply put
- Conclude: repeat yourself, but differently
- Style manuals: IEEE, APA (technical); MLA, Chicago, Harvard, APA (humanities)

Key dates

- Achebe 1930-2013; *Things Fall Apart* 1958
- Nigerian civil war 1967-70; 'Civil Peace' 1971
- Mansfield 1888-1923
- Wordsworth Preface 1800
- Fish, *How to Write a Sentence* 2012
- Picasso, *Portrait of Wilhelm Uhde* 1910

1

Communication and idea generation

Lecture L2 · General strategies for cogent writing



Success = the decoded message matches what the sender meant (PLOT is what makes it clear)

The communication process from L2

The literary narrative is treated as a story, event or concept to be communicated. The lecture then asks: **what is successful communication?** Answer: a well-developed **plot**.

Ideas about sentences and poetry

- **Stanley Fish**, *How to Write a Sentence: And How to Read One* (2012). Before words slide into their slots they are just discrete items. Examples come from Mark Twain ("If you tell the truth, you don't have to remember anything"; "Buy land, they're not making it anymore"). A student sentence, "I was already on the second floor when I heard about the box," generates **anticipation** because it makes the reader want to know more. Fish's point: following grammar rules is important, but **precision of thought** is equally necessary.
- **Wordsworth**, Preface to *Lyrical Ballads* (1800): poetry is the "spontaneous overflow of powerful feelings" that takes its origin from emotion recollected in tranquility.

Generating ideas

- **Define the problem and your task:** (a) identify what has to be addressed, (b) determine how to address it.
- Note: communication is **not merely conveying information**, and good communication is often **socially negotiated problem solving**.
- **Brainstorming** is primarily intuitive, can be collaborative, generates numerous perspectives, and leads to evaluation and organisation.

Exploring the subject: Aristotle's common topics

Topic	Sub-ideas to think with
Definition	Genus / division
Comparison	Similarity, difference, degree
Relationship	Cause, effect, antecedent, consequence, contraries, contradictions
Circumstance	Possible, impossible, past fact, future fact
Testimony	Authority, testimonials, statistics, maxims, law, precedents, examples

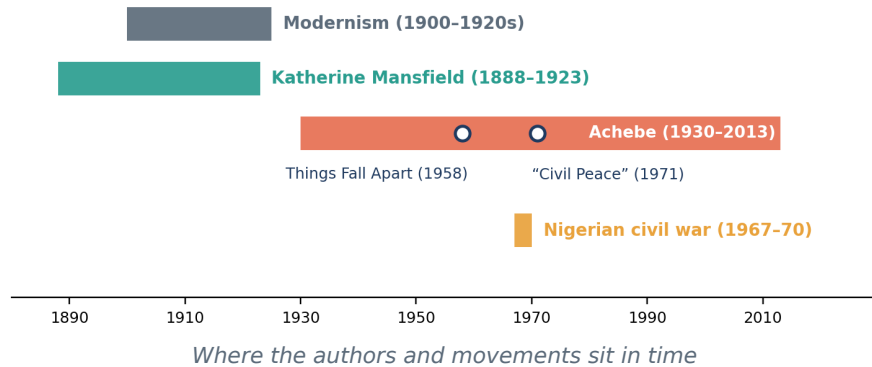
Identifying audiences and purposes

- Identify the **uses** of your communication and the **routes** it will travel.
- Consider the impact of co-operative, controversial and ethical ideas.
- Consider the impact of **distortion, incompleteness, inaccuracy and bias**.

2

Achebe, Nigeria and African storytelling

Lectures L2 and L3



Chinua Achebe (1930-2013)

- Nigerian, from the **Igbo** community. *Things Fall Apart* (1958) is his magnum opus.
- Active in Nigerian politics; worked to support common people during the civil war; professor of **Africana Studies at Brown University**, USA.
- "Civil Peace" (1971): the **title is ironic**; it shows Achebe as writer and activist, comments on violence and corruption within the state, shows devastation during war, and ends as a tale of optimism and human resilience.

The Nigerian civil war (1967-70)

- A civil war is a war between two factions within the same nation, or two countries that once formed a nation.
- Also called the Nigerian-Biafran war: **Biafra** became a self-proclaimed republic but was finally reabsorbed into Nigeria.
- Chief causes were **cultural and economic**, arising from an **arbitrary division of the continent by the British**.

The short story and Africa

- Draws from an **oral heritage**.
- Colonization: the slave trade and slave narratives in the 18th century.
- Imprints of the **Negritude movement** in the 20th century: a political and literary movement started in **France by the African diaspora in the 1930s**, against French racism and rule (France was the second-largest colonizer after Britain).
- **Achebe's position: both oral storytelling and Negritude.**

3

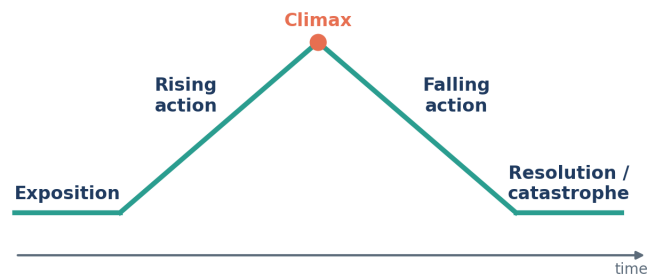
Plot: literature and communication

Lecture L3

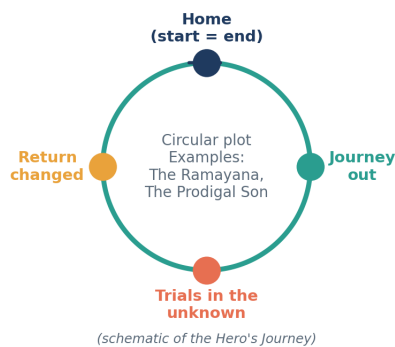
Plot in literature

- Literature (imaginative communication) is about **narratives / stories**. Every story has a **goal or conclusion**, open or closed.
- The goal is to convey a message, idea or situation. That message is **always open to interpretation**.
- The goal (communicating clearly) is reached through **plot**: the more developed the plot, the more accurate the communication.
- **Plot = the arrangement of events in a narrative**. The sequence differs from narrative to narrative (you can begin with the beginning, middle or end); it creates suspense, climax and resolution, then a conclusion.

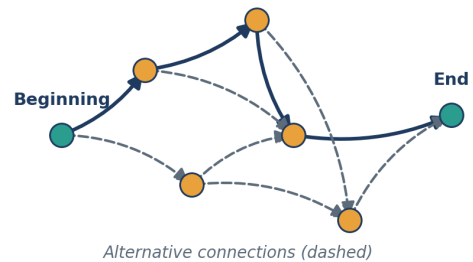
Five types of plot



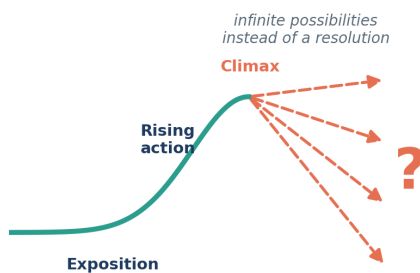
Linear plot: Freytag's pyramid (exposition, rising action, climax, falling action, resolution)



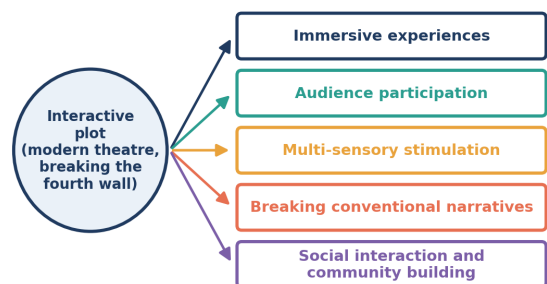
Circular: the Hero's Journey (redrawn schematic)



Non-linear: many epics, contemporary plots



Open-ended: infinite possibilities instead of resolution or catastrophe



Interactive: modern theatre ("The Rise of Interactive Theatre")

Choosing the right plot for yourself: (1) your role and audience expectations, (2) audience's requirements, (3) channels of communication, (4) end goal.

Plot in "Civil Peace" (how the lecture uses the story)

- The story's goal is to present **Nigeria, Nigerians, colonizers' influence on politics and economy, and an emerging nation** in a certain light.
- It does this through **plot** (sequencing ideas and events) and through **language that communicates and invokes images**.

4

Modernism, modern art and Camus

Lecture L4 · Katherine Mansfield's context

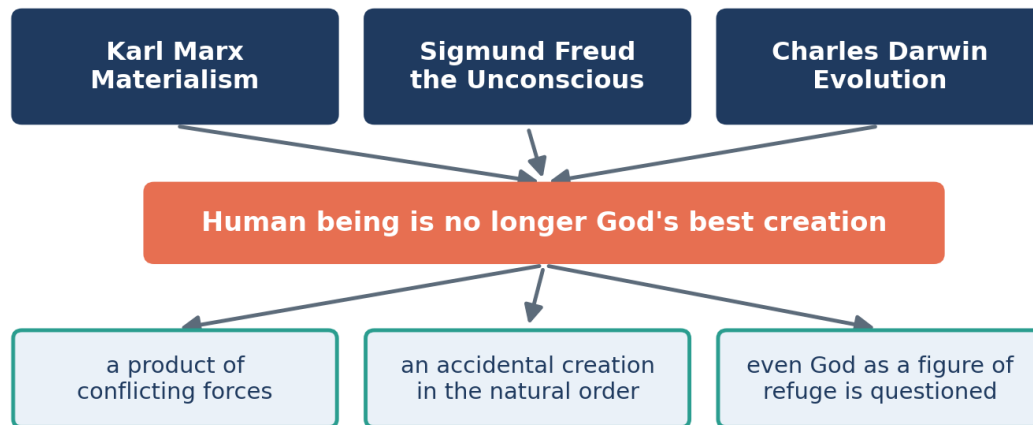
Katherine Mansfield (1888-1923)

- Born in New Zealand to English parents; migrated to England at 19.
- A pre-eminent writer of the English short story, in the **Modernist** tradition.

What Modernism was

- A movement in **Western society**, late 19th to early 20th centuries (**1900-1920s**), shaped by the West's **losing political dominance** over the world and by the **world-war** experience.

- It began as a **rebellion against traditional value systems**: questioning and rejecting ideals such as an all-powerful God and moral codes. It encouraged **re-examination and introspection**.



Precursors of Modernist thought and their consequence for how humans see themselves

Modern art (symbolises change and experimentalism, questions norms; stresses individualism, alienation and existentialism)

Movement / work	Key points from the slides
Cubism	Pablo Picasso, <i>Portrait of Wilhelm Uhde</i> (1910)
Dada	French for ' nonsense '; grew out of the world war. Marcel Duchamp (Dadaist) reworked the Mona Lisa: " Destruction is also creation. " Raoul Hausmann, <i>Mechanical Head (The Spirit of Our Time)</i>
Surrealism	Centred in Paris ; proponents of Dadaism and Surrealism: Marcel Duchamp and André Breton (French artists). Rafał Olbiński (Polish) shown as an example
Magritte	<i>La Reproduction Interdite (The Forbidden Reproduction)</i> : read as colonialists fashioning natives after themselves

The Myth of Sisyphus and Absurdism

- **Sisyphus** was a classical Greek king who cheated the gods and tried to bring immortality to humankind, so **Zeus** punished him. The myth reminds us of human mortality and divine immortality.
- **Albert Camus** (20th-century French philosopher), *The Myth of Sisyphus* (1942): the **absurd** comes with the realization that the world is not rational; at this point humanity stands face to face with the irrational.
- The **absurd hero**; the futility of human efforts to gain clarity and meaning in an absurd, godless world. Camus's philosophy lies **beyond despair and hope**.
- The slide links loneliness, individualism and empowerment to the Western worldview, in contrast to Eastern cultures that celebrate communal duties and community over the individual.

5

The two stories at a glance

Lectures L3 and L5 · no direct questions expected, but useful for comprehension passages

	Civil Peace (Achebe)	The Fly (Mansfield)
Setting	Post-war Nigeria (Biafran war aftermath); Africa: poverty, struggle for survival, loss	Post-war Europe: wealth, emotional trauma
Central figure	Jonathan Iwegbu, a war survivor who counts himself lucky	The boss, proud, successful, healthy but alone; old Woodifield has a family but is poor
Shared ground	War victims; grieving fathers; loss and trauma	War victims; grieving fathers of sons lost to conscription
Plot shape	Opening sentence sets a lucky, thankful tone; small material gains (bicycle, house, family businesses); high point = the windfall (ex gratia, "egg-rasher"); caution and joy foretell mishap; the robbery; the family's stoic morning-after return to business	Starts with the two men "snug" in the parlor; contrast is set but so is similarity; we hear of the boss's love for his son late; we wait to see him grieve; instead he watches a fly, is deeply cruel, and kills it; he forgets his trauma, numbed
Style / device	Repetition of "Nothing puzzles God!"; the ironic title; heroism of ordinary people	Contrast between the two old men; the fly episode as a substitute for grief
Big idea	Human resilience and optimism amid devastation	Loss of human emotion due to war

Lecture point about beginnings: the opening of "Civil Peace" ("counted himself extra-ordinarily lucky... 'Happy survival!'") sets the tone. The lecture asks you to imagine a different beginning, such as the robbery or the rubble around the house, and notice how the tone would change. **Plot choices shape tone.**

6

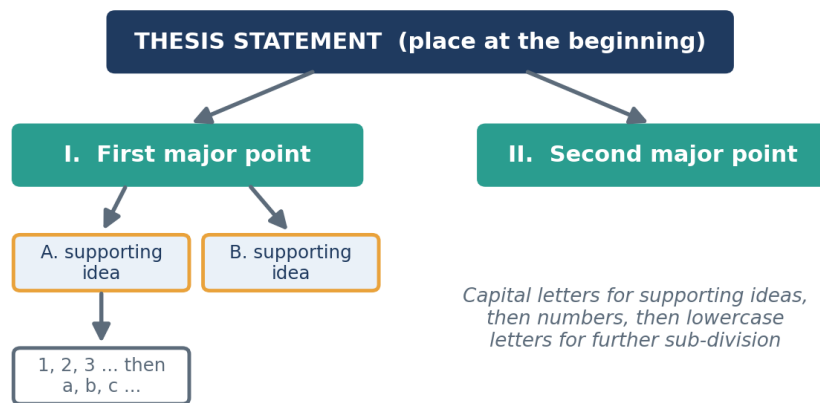
Arguments and scholarly communication

Lecture L6

Constructing arguments

- **Keywords: 5-7.** Form a potential thesis / topic sentence (the main point of view) in **25-30 words**. Then organise ideas in an outline.
- A thesis, per the Cambridge Dictionary, is a long piece of writing on a particular subject, especially for a higher college or university degree.
- Thesis statements, from a statement to an essay: for "An analysis of the college admission process reveals *one challenge* faced by counselors..." the essay should explain **both** the analysis and the challenge. For "High school graduates should take a year off for community service..." the essay must present an **argument with evidence**.

Outline and stages of argument formation



Outline labelling: thesis, then I / II, then A / B, then 1 / 2 / 3, then a / b / c

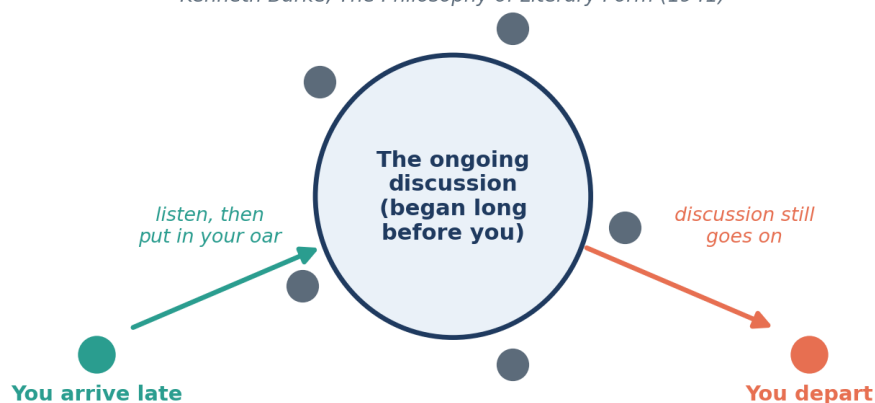
- Stages: **Main point** (good topic sentence or clear introduction) → 1. first main line of argument → A. first sub-argument → i), ii), iii) proofs → B. second sub-argument, and so on.

Points to remember (formal writing)

- Your arguments must be sensitive to **glocal** requirements.
- To disagree with someone in formal communication, use **facts and evidence**.
- Avoid personal attacks and remarks.
- Use humour only to **defuse difficult situations**; never to mock or put down people in formal writing.

Scholarly communication: building knowledge systems

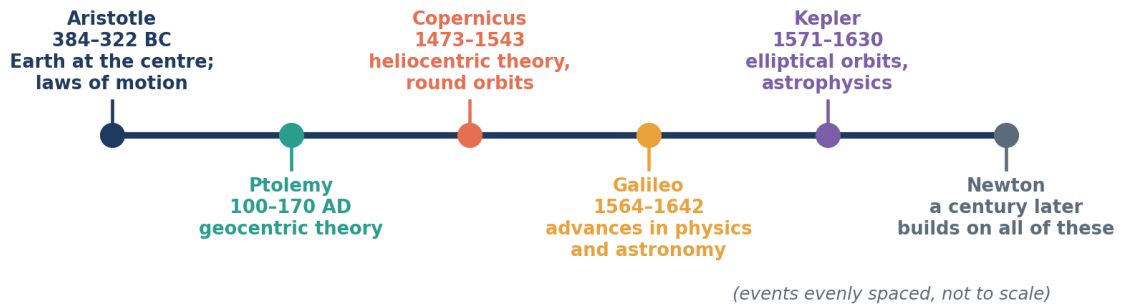
Kenneth Burke, *The Philosophy of Literary Form* (1941)



The Burkean parlor

- Parlor** = a place for receiving guests; from Anglo-Norman French *parlur* ('place for speaking'), from Latin *parlare* ('speak').
- Kenneth Burke's image: you enter a discussion that began long before you; nobody can retrace it all for you; you listen, then join in; allies and opponents respond; the hour grows late and you leave, but the discussion carries on.
- Burkean parlor of scholarly communication:** scholarly communication matters over time and generations; accurately recording data is key to creating systems of knowledge; accuracy depends on how data is presented (plotted, argued, archived); we are all **filling gaps** in existing scholarship as we add new ideas, concepts and data sets.
- Knowledge systems** do not exist in a vacuum; they develop over time and converse with older ones, and newer knowledge is born through that continuum. Scholarly recording is key to **synthesising new ideas from older ones**.

Worked example of that continuum: from Aristotle to Newton



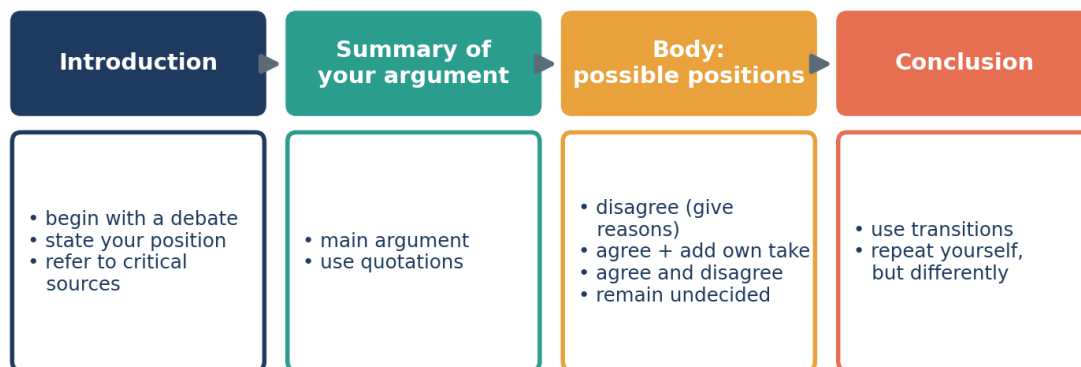
Planet Earth: each thinker responds to the earlier ones

Copernicus's followers, such as Bruno, were burnt by the Church for heresy. Kepler contributed elliptical orbits and advances in astrophysics; Newton in England built on these a century later.

7

Writing an essay: templates and style manuals

Lecture L7 · templates from Graff and Birkenstein, They Say, I Say



Structure of the essay, following the L7 slides

Style manuals across disciplines

Field	Manuals
Technical and scientific research writing	IEEE (Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers) manual; APA (American Psychological Association) manual
Social sciences and humanities	MLA Handbook; Chicago Style Manual; Harvard Style Manual; APA Style Manual

Template moves (the slides fill these in with Achebe and "Civil Peace")

Part	Move	Shape of the template
Introduction	Begin with a debate	"In discussing X, one often claims ____ (Author, page). On the one hand, ____ argue _____. On the other hand, ____ contend _____. Others maintain _____. My own view is _____."
Introduction	State your position	"I've always believed that ____ has had its merits and demerits... Reading the story I cannot help thinking _____. At the same time, I believe ____ and also _____."
Introduction	Refer to critical sources	"A number of scholars have suggested that _____. It has become common today to state _____. In their recent work A and B claim _____." Cite as you go.
Summary	Main argument and quotations	"[Author] hails ____ and his hero presents a glorious example of ____ by _____. He admits: '____'. Accordingly, I reaffirm _____."
Body	Disagree, with reasons	"Scholar A is mistaken about ____ because she ignores the fact that _____." / "I disagree with A's view that ____ because recent studies have revealed _____."
Body	Agree and add your own take	"I agree that X's views on ____; this is because my own experience ____ confirms it." / "X's theory is extremely useful here because it sheds light on _____."
Body	Agree and disagree at once	"Though I concede ____, I still insist that _____." / "While the author is perhaps too idealistic when he states ____, he is right when he _____."
Body	Remain undecided	"I am on two minds about _____. On the one hand I agree that _____. On the other hand, I am not sure whether _____."
Conclusion	Repeat yourself, but differently	"In sum, my argument is _____." / "To conclude, I would like to reiterate that _____." / "By realistically depicting the perils ____, the author reaffirms the age-old philosophy that _____."

Transitions for the conclusion: as a result · after all · in short · finally · to summarize · in sum · simply put. **Whenever you cite or borrow, give a reference in parentheses** following the style manual you are working with.

8

Writing well: final points

Lecture L8 · Written communication

The slides open with a montage of early humans, cave paintings and an inscribed tablet under the heading **Good communication: effective problem solving since the dawn of civilization**. The rest of the lecture is about writing choices.

What is central to good writing

Sequencing of ideas



Grammar



Sequencing of ideas, then grammar

Writerly writing: the erroneous sentence (common mistakes)

Sentence on the slide	Error the slide names
"Being the most spectacular event in the nation, newspapers were obligated to devote major coverage to the hurricane."	The opening phrase attaches to the wrong noun: newspapers were not the most spectacular event (a modifier problem)
"He had arrive at his home town."	Tense (wrong verb form after 'had')
"Either the physicians in this hospital or the chief administrator are going to have to make a decision."	Subject-verb agreement (with either/or the verb agrees with the nearer subject, so 'is')

Complex academic writing and creative writing

- **Complex theoretical/academic writing:** the slide shows a dense, abstract passage from Michel Foucault's *Discipline and Punish* (1977), arguing that the soul is an effect and instrument of political power ("the soul is the prison of the body"). It is the opposite of readerly writing.
- **Creative writing:** examples from Arundhati Roy's *The God of Small Things*. A **simile** compares one thing with another of a different kind to make a description more emphatic or vivid: a face pale and wrinkled like a dhobi's thumb after too long in water; still birds sliding along moving wires like unclaimed baggage at an airport; history's smell like old roses on a breeze.
- **Neologisms** (newly invented words) from the same book: "getting-outedness", "Bar Nowl", "viable-dieable age".

Verb tenses

- **Northern Illinois University:** in formal writing keep verb tenses consistent so readers can follow ideas and arguments. **In creative writing tenses may be inconsistent for effect**, but in academic writing be consistent throughout and signal any necessary shift.
- **Purdue OWL:** unnecessary or inconsistent shifts cause confusion; writers generally keep **one tense for the main discourse**; a change in time frame is shown by changing tense **relative to the primary tense** (usually simple past or simple present); even non-narrative writing needs consistent, clear tenses.
- **Consistency and elegance:** sentences must be balanced and consistent. Errors involve verb and pronoun usage. If a sentence begins in the past tense it must stay there. Do not shift tense if the time frame is the same. Example on the slide: "*The instructor explains the diagram to students who asked questions during the lecture*" mixes present and past.
- **Pronouns** must be consistent in person and number; a shift from singular *I* to plural *we* leaves the reader unsure who is doing what.
- **Incorrect tenses (worked example):** a passage about Elizabeth Peabody uses *was*, *felt*, *thrived* (past) with *trains*, *seems* (present). All the action happened in the past, so all verbs should be past.

Parallel structure

✗ Juan loves skating and to read.

skating (participle) vs to read (infinitive):
the pair is not grammatically parallel

✓ Juan loves skating and reading.

✓ Juan loves to skate and to read.

Change either item so both follow the same pattern

Pairs and lists must follow the same grammatical pattern

- Parallel structure involves pairs and lists of words and phrases; **all items must follow the same grammatical pattern**.
- Journalism example: the list *reading, watching, and you should read* breaks the pattern. Fix: *reading a variety of newspapers, watching documentaries and televised news programs, and reading books about world leaders...*
- Parallelism example: *the more I read..., the more it makes me want...* is faulty because the phrases after "the more" are not grammatical equivalents. *It makes me* should be matched with *I want to*: **the more I**

read..., the more I want to get out there and try it.

Active and passive voice

ACTIVE (direct, shorter)



PASSIVE (subject is acted upon; wordy, lacks focus)



Compare the two sentences in each pair from the slide

- In the passive voice the **subject is acted upon**. Passive constructions tend to be wordy or lack focus, so most sentences should be active.
- More pairs on the slide: *I misplaced my wallet / My wallet was misplaced by me; The administration has selected three finalists / Three finalists have been selected by the administration.*

When passive voice is acceptable (University of Toronto advice on the slides)

- **The actor is unknown:** the cave paintings of Lascaux were made in the Upper Old Stone Age.
- **The actor is irrelevant:** an experimental solar power plant will be built in the Australian desert.
- **You want to be vague about who is responsible:** "Mistakes were made" (common in bureaucratic writing).
- **You are talking about a general truth:** rules are made to be broken.

Readerly writing checklist: simple and precise · sticks to the rules of grammar · chronological · without contradictions · without complexity.

9

Writing rules, AI ethics and plagiarism

From the writing lecture notes

Common mistake	What it means	Example from the notes
Tenses (discontinuity)	Switching between past, present and future without reason	"Once upon a time there was a king. He is the greatest monarch... he will be planning a war..."
Use active voice	Make the doer the subject	Weak: "When John offers Tim's mother to help with his education, she becomes liberated of a burden." Better: "When John offers to educate Tim, he relieves his mother of a burden."
Excessive wordiness / repetition	Saying the same thing twice	"children are curious and often of mischievous attitude" (Tagore example)
Incomplete / incongruous sentences	A sentence promises something it never delivers	"On the other hand, Tagore feels..." with no earlier "on the one hand"
Too many ideas in one sentence	Split it up	Long Tagore sentence packing the child's growth, family finance, widowed mother and moral codes into one line
Gender-sensitive writing	Be gender inclusive	Avoid: "If one seeks to learn what interests him, he would..."
Avoid abbreviations	Write things out in formal prose	&, etc., e.g.

Generative AI and plagiarism

- GenAI is programmed to generate answers whether or not it has appropriate ones. **Students cannot blame AI for errors**; they remain accountable for everything they submit.
- AI can carry **bias or inaccuracy** and can strengthen and magnify existing biases in its training data. **Human supervision is critical.**
- Ethical use: **ensure attribution, double-check against bias**, and provide education and training for researchers and recipients.
- **Plagiarism = unacknowledged copying.** Using archival or existing critical data is fully accepted, but **acknowledgement is mandatory.**

10

Comprehension-passage tips

General exam technique, not from the slides

- **Read the questions first**, then the passage, so you know what to hunt for.
- Find the **main idea and the author's purpose** in one sentence before you look at options. The lectures keep asking: what is the goal of this text and how does the plot or structure achieve it?
- Look for **tone** and where it shifts. Lecture examples: an ironic title, a hopeful opening line that sets the tone, contrast between two characters.
- Answer **only from the passage**. Options that sound true in general but are not supported by the text are usually the trap.
- Be wary of extreme words (always, never, only, all) unless the passage is equally extreme.
- Use the lecture vocabulary: plot, exposition, climax, resolution, irony, tone, thesis, argument, evidence, audience, purpose, bias.
- There is **no negative marking**, so guess when unsure after eliminating what you can.

11

Practice MCQs (50 questions)

Do it cold, then check the key that follows

1. What is the order of the communication process in the L2 slides?

- A.** Sender → Encoded message → Receiver → Decoded message
- B.** Sender → Receiver → Encoded message → Decoded message
- C.** Encoded message → Sender → Decoded message → Receiver
- D.** Receiver → Encoded message → Sender → Decoded message

3. Which is NOT one of Aristotle's common topics on the slide?

- A.** Narration
- B.** Testimony
- C.** Comparison
- D.** Definition

5. Cause, effect, antecedent, consequence and contraries fall under:

- A.** Definition
- B.** Testimony
- C.** Relationship
- D.** Circumstance

7. Brainstorming is described as primarily:

- A.** statistical
- B.** intuitive
- C.** legalistic
- D.** solitary

9. Which is NOT part of 'Identifying Audiences and Purposes'?

- A.** Uses of your communication and the routes it will travel
- B.** Impact of co-operative, controversial and ethical ideas
- C.** Impact of distortion, incompleteness, inaccuracy and bias
- D.** Choosing the font size of the final document

11. Achebe's position on African storytelling traditions was:

- A.** both oral storytelling and Negritude
- B.** only written literature
- C.** only Negritude
- D.** neither

2. Wordsworth's Preface to Lyrical Ballads (1800) describes poetry as:

- A.** the imitation of nature
- B.** the spontaneous overflow of powerful feelings
- C.** the music of reason
- D.** a mirror held up to society

4. Authority, testimonials, statistics, maxims, law, precedents and examples fall under:

- A.** Relationship
- B.** Comparison
- C.** Testimony
- D.** Circumstance

6. Possible, impossible, past fact and future fact fall under:

- A.** Relationship
- B.** Comparison
- C.** Definition
- D.** Circumstance

8. Good communication is often:

- A.** the mere conveying of information
- B.** free of audience concerns
- C.** a one-way transfer
- D.** socially negotiated problem solving

10. Negritude began:

- A.** in the United States in the 1960s
- B.** in France, by the African diaspora in the 1930s
- C.** in Britain in the 18th century
- D.** in Nigeria after 1970

12. The Nigerian civil war (Nigerian-Biafran war) took place in:

- A.** 1958-61
- B.** 1967-70
- C.** 1939-45
- D.** 1914-18

13. The chief causes of the Nigerian civil war were:

- A.** a war against France
- B.** cultural and economic, from an arbitrary division of the continent by the British
- C.** purely religious
- D.** a dispute over a single election

15. In Freytag's pyramid, what comes right after the climax?

- A.** Rising action
- B.** Falling action
- C.** Exposition
- D.** Interactive phase

17. An open-ended narrative plot is one where:

- A.** the ending is always tragic
- B.** the audience decides the middle
- C.** the end may have infinite possibilities instead of a resolution
- D.** the story loops back to the start

19. Which is NOT a factor in choosing the right plot?

- A.** End goal
- B.** The writer's birthplace
- C.** Your role and audience expectations
- D.** Channels of communication

21. The Modernist movement is dated roughly to:

- A.** 1800–1830
- B.** 1950–1970
- C.** 1900–1920s
- D.** 1600–1650

23. Proponents of Dadaism and Surrealism named on the slide were:

- A.** Pablo Picasso and Claude Monet
- B.** Camus and Sartre
- C.** Marcel Duchamp and André Breton
- D.** Kepler and Galileo

25. Camus's *The Myth of Sisyphus* was published in:

- A.** 1971
- B.** 1942
- C.** 1800
- D.** 1958

27. In an outline, major points supporting the thesis are labelled with:

- A.** numbers (1, 2, 3)
- B.** Roman numerals (I, II, III)
- C.** lowercase letters (a, b, c)
- D.** capital letters (A, B, C)

14. Plot is best defined as:

- A.** the author's biography
- B.** the setting of a story
- C.** the moral of a story
- D.** the arrangement of events in a narrative

16. A circular plot is illustrated by:

- A.** a Freytag pyramid
- B.** the Hero's Journey (e.g. *The Ramayana*)
- C.** a contemporary non-linear film
- D.** interactive theatre

18. Interactive plot is associated with:

- A.** Freytag's pyramid
- B.** letters and memos
- C.** medieval epics
- D.** modern theatre that breaks the fourth wall

20. Which pairing of precursor and idea is correct?

- A.** Marx: Evolution
- B.** Freud: Materialism
- C.** Darwin: Materialism
- D.** Freud: the Unconscious

22. 'Dada' is French for:

- A.** nonsense
- B.** dream
- C.** father
- D.** machine

24. For Camus, the absurd arises from:

- A.** a belief in progress
- B.** the realization that the world is not rational
- C.** the rejection of all art
- D.** a lack of education

26. The slides suggest keywords and thesis length of:

- A.** 2–3 keywords; 5-word thesis
- B.** 10–15 keywords; 100-word thesis
- C.** 5–7 keywords; 25–30 word thesis
- D.** no set length

28. The Burkean parlor is a metaphor for:

- A.** private note-taking
- B.** a formal debate with a winner
- C.** a place to store archives
- D.** scholarly conversation that began before you and continues after you leave

29. Which thinker proposed the heliocentric theory?

- A.** Ptolemy
- B.** Aristotle
- C.** Copernicus
- D.** Newton

31. "Once upon a time there was a king. He is the greatest monarch of all times." illustrates which mistake?

- A.** Tense discontinuity
- B.** Gender bias
- C.** Too many ideas in one sentence
- D.** Passive voice

33. Which manuals are listed for technical and scientific research writing?

- A.** Harvard only
- B.** None
- C.** IEEE and APA
- D.** MLA and Chicago

35. Plagiarism is defined in the notes as:

- A.** quoting with a citation
- B.** unacknowledged copying
- C.** paraphrasing with a citation
- D.** using any critical data

37. 'Either the physicians ... or the chief administrator are going to have to make a decision.' The slide names the error as:

- A.** Pronoun shift
- B.** Subject-verb agreement
- C.** Tense
- D.** Parallelism

39. A simile is:

- A.** a newly invented word
- B.** a repeated phrase
- C.** the use of the passive voice
- D.** a comparison of one thing with another of a different kind to make description more vivid

41. According to the tense slides, verb tenses may be used inconsistently for effect in:

- A.** technical manuals
- B.** academic writing
- C.** formal reports
- D.** creative writing

30. According to the L6 points to remember, humour in formal writing:

- A.** is encouraged to mock opponents
- B.** should be used only to defuse difficult situations
- C.** should never be used at all
- D.** is fine when the audience agrees

32. "If one seeks to learn what interests him, he would..." is a problem because it is:

- A.** incomplete
- B.** too wordy
- C.** in the passive voice
- D.** not gender inclusive

34. According to the notes on generative AI, who is accountable for errors in submitted work?

- A.** The AI
- B.** Nobody
- C.** The student
- D.** The university library

36. The sentence 'He had arrive at his home town' has which error, according to the slide?

- A.** Subject-verb agreement
- B.** Passive voice
- C.** Parallel structure
- D.** Tense

38. In 'Being the most spectacular event in the nation, newspapers were obligated to devote major coverage to the hurricane', what is wrong?

- A.** The opening phrase wrongly describes the newspapers
- B.** It lacks a subject
- C.** The verb tense is inconsistent
- D.** It uses passive voice

40. Neologisms (as in 'Bar Nowl' from The God of Small Things) are:

- A.** grammatical equivalents
- B.** newly invented words
- C.** errors of tense
- D.** words borrowed from Latin

42. Purdue OWL says writers indicate a change in time frame by:

- A.** changing tense relative to the primary tense
- B.** switching pronouns
- C.** starting a new paragraph
- D.** using the passive voice

43. 'The instructor explains the diagram to students who asked questions during the lecture' is a problem because:

- A.** it shifts tense within the same time frame
- B.** it is in the passive voice
- C.** the subject is missing
- D.** it uses too many adjectives

45. 'The more I read about deep sea fishing, the more it makes me want...' is faulty because:

- A.** it uses passive voice
- B.** the phrases after 'the more' are not grammatical equivalents
- C.** it changes tense
- D.** it is too long

47. Which is an acceptable use of the passive, per the University of Toronto slide?

- A.** Three finalists were selected by the administration.
- B.** The cave paintings of Lascaux were made in the Upper Old Stone Age (actor unknown).
- C.** Another helping was asked for by my friend.
- D.** My wallet was misplaced by me (actor obvious).

49. Which set describes 'readerly writing' on the slide?

- A.** Dense, abstract and theory-heavy
- B.** Full of invented words and unusual similes
- C.** Simple and precise, grammatical, chronological, without contradictions or complexity
- D.** Written mainly in the passive voice

44. Which sentence is grammatically parallel?

- A.** Juan loves to skate and reading.
- B.** Juan loves skating and reading.
- C.** Juan loves skate and to read.
- D.** Juan loves skating and to read.

46. Which sentence is in the passive voice?

- A.** The administration has selected three finalists.
- B.** My wallet was misplaced by me.
- C.** My friend asked for another helping.
- D.** I misplaced my wallet.

48. 'Mistakes were made' illustrates passive voice used when:

- A.** you are stating a general truth
- B.** you want to be vague about who is responsible
- C.** the actor is unknown
- D.** the actor is irrelevant

50. Which is NOT part of 'Sequencing of ideas' in the L8 slide?

- A.** Know the existing conversation
- B.** Collect ideas
- C.** Algorithmic progression of argument
- D.** Choosing a font



Answer key

With a one-line reason for each

#	Ans	Why
1	A	The chain runs sender, encoded message, receiver, decoded message.
2	B	Origin: emotion recollected in tranquility.
3	A	The five are Definition, Comparison, Relationship, Circumstance, Testimony.
4	C	That whole list is under Testimony.
5	C	Relationship.
6	D	Circumstance.
7	B	Also collaborative, many perspectives, leads to evaluation and organisation.
8	D	The slide says communication is not merely conveying information.
9	D	Font size is not on the slide.
10	B	Against French racism and rule.
11	A	Both.
12	B	1967–70.
13	B	Cultural and economic.
14	D	Arrangement of events; the sequence differs from narrative to narrative.
15	B	Order: exposition, rising, climax, falling, resolution.
16	B	Circular: Hero's Journey.
17	C	No fixed resolution or catastrophe.
18	D	Audience participation, immersive experiences.
19	B	Four factors: role/audience expectations, audience's requirements, channels, end goal.
20	D	Marx: Materialism; Freud: Unconscious; Darwin: Evolution.
21	C	Late 19th to early 20th centuries.
22	A	Dada arose in the wake of the world war.
23	C	French artists.
24	B	Humanity stands face to face with the irrational.
25	B	1942.
26	C	Keywords 5–7; thesis 25–30 words.
27	B	Then capital letters for supporting ideas, then numbers, then lowercase.
28	D	Kenneth Burke, 1941.
29	C	Ptolemy was geocentric.
30	B	Never to mock or put down people.
31	A	Past, present and future are mixed.
32	D	Use gender-inclusive language.
33	C	MLA, Chicago, Harvard and APA are for social sciences and humanities.
34	C	Students cannot blame AI.
35	B	Acknowledgement is mandatory.
36	D	The slide labels it a tense error.
37	B	With either/or, the verb agrees with the nearer subject.
38	A	Newspapers were not the most spectacular event; the hurricane was.
39	D	Arundhati Roy's similes were the slide examples.
40	B	Neo = new; logos = word.
41	D	Academic writing should be consistent and signal any shifts.

#	Ans	Why
42	A	The primary tense is usually simple past or simple present.
43	A	Explains (present) and asked (past) describe the same time frame.
44	B	Skating/to read mixes a participle with an infinitive.
45	B	'It makes me' should be matched with 'I want to'.
46	B	The subject (wallet) is acted upon.
47	B	Passive works when the actor is unknown, irrelevant, to be left vague, or for a general truth.
48	B	Common in bureaucratic writing.
49	C	Readerly = easy for the reader to follow.
50	D	The list: collect ideas, know the existing conversation, keywords, thesis statement, algorithmic progression.

Past-paper appendix

Transcribed from your uploaded scan, question text only

Source and method

The uploaded file is a phone-photographed, graded answer script of two quizzes from an earlier offering of this course: **Quiz 1** and **Quiz 2**, Communication Skills (LA 1760/10760), IIT Hyderabad, each worth 50 marks. Both follow the exact format your course announced: bubble-sheet MCQs, no negative marking, 5 lettered sections.

The pages that follow reproduce the **question text and options exactly as printed**, with section headers and instructions verbatim. The scanned copy is a **graded** script — it carries a student's pencil-filled bubbles and a grader's red-pen marks. Those marks belong to one student's attempt, not to the exam itself, so they are **not reproduced here**; only the questions and answer choices are transcribed.

One gap: Quiz 1's page 6 was not present in the scan. It held the header and first four questions (26–29) of Section D, a five-question reading passage (about Mesoamerican pyramids) parallel in structure to Sections C and E. Only question 30, the last of that section, survived on the following page — it is included below with the missing context noted.

General Instructions: please read very carefully:

- This question paper has 5 questions, A to E
- Use a blue/black pen
- Fill the correct answer as a bubble
- If two options are simultaneously chosen for one question, it will be marked wrong
- Read instructions very carefully and answer all questions
- Write your name and roll number
- No negative marking
- Use of mobile phones/internet not allowed

A. Carefully read the following questions on academic/professional communication and choose the most appropriate answer (1×10=10 marks)**1. In academic/formal writing it is fine to be**

- a. Controversial and insulting
- b. Biased and inflexible
- c. Undecided yet informed
- d. None of the above

2. For writing well informed formal articles, one should

- a. Never repeat what has been said
- b. Refer but with acknowledgements
- c. Always and only refer to others
- d. Try only self-referencing

3. While disagreeing with existing scholarship as you write an article, you must

- a. Back your criticism with facts
- b. Aggressively attack what you disagree with
- c. Simply ignore what you disagree with
- d. All of the above

4. When you write an academic article by foregrounding your own position on a topic, you should

- a. Strongly claim the validity of your arguments
- b. Provide facts supporting the validity of your arguments
- c. Avoid all existing scholarly references on the topic
- d. None of the above

5. In an academic article if you agree with existing scholarship but have more information to add, you should

- a. Acknowledge existing information
- b. Claim you are bridging a gap in scholarship
- c. Provide your own take on the issue
- d. All of the above

6. While writing a formal article, if you choose to agree and disagree simultaneously with existing scholarship you should

- a. Ignore the ideas you disagree with
- b. Provide facts for your disagreement
- c. Never mention reasons for your disagreement
- d. Provoke readers to disagree along with you

7. As you conclude a formal article, you should

- a. Reiterate your larger argument
- b. Never repeat yourself
- c. Try using others' ideas to support your own
- d. All of the above

8. A thesis statement helps you in

- a. Summarizing data you will reject
- b. Summarizing your central argument
- c. Summarizing your data collection
- d. None of the above

9. As you begin working on a formal piece of written communication that will be read by others, it is most important that you keep in mind

- a. Your own background
- b. Who your reader is
- c. Whether you like the topic or not
- d. None of the above

10. Historically, most human communication has been about

- a. Passing information
- b. Having fun
- c. Keeping secrets
- d. Forgetting incidents

B. From the following questions on communication in its various forms, choose the most appropriate answer (1×10=10 marks)

11. Academic plagiarism includes

- a. Unacknowledged copying
- b. Duplication of others' ideas
- c. Using others' ideas and claiming originality
- d. All of the above
- e. None of the above

12. To avoid plagiarism, one should

- a. Stop borrowing others' ideas
- b. Use existing ideas with proper acknowledgement
- c. Never acknowledge borrowing others' ideas
- d. None of the above

13. While using AI for getting solutions for academic questions, it is important to remember that

- a. AI is programmed to respond to all questions
- b. AI requires human scrutiny
- c. AI is likely to have algorithmic bias
- d. All of the above
- e. None of the above

14. One of the most important things scholars need to do with AI is

- a. Ensure that inclusive and unbiased data is used
- b. Ensure that all AI systems are developed in Western laboratories alone
- c. Ensure that only highly technically trained individuals use AI
- d. All of the above

15. When using AI for academic writing, one must

- a. Ensure attribution of source
- b. Double check against bias and inaccuracy
- c. Never copy without acknowledgement
- d. All of the above

16. One of the main concerns with using AI for mitigating human problems is

- a. Data generated can be faulty and inaccurate
- b. Data generated can be from global sources
- c. Data generated is available very fast
- d. All of the above

17. To be an empathetic communicator, one needs to

- a. Try correcting the other person's mistakes
- b. Amuse the other person
- c. Try being in the other person's shoes
- d. Try avoiding the other person

18. In effective communication, one needs to be

- a. Firm and aggressive
- b. Firm and submissive
- c. Firm and amusing
- d. Firm and polite

19. In formal communication, the best way to handle criticism is to

- a. Distinguish between hurtful and helpful criticism
- b. Aggressively fight back to stop the critic
- c. Reject all criticism and keep working
- d. All of the above

20. Humor in formal communication

- a. Should be avoided at all costs
- b. Should always be present
- c. Should be used to diffuse unpleasantness
- d. Should be used to ridicule others

C. Read the following passage and choose the most appropriate answers for the questions that follow (2×5=10 marks)

Saving energy means saving money. Homeowners and renters know this basic fact, but they often don't know what kinds of adjustments they can make in their homes and apartments that will result in savings.

For those willing to spend some time and money to reap long-term energy savings, an energy audit is the way to go. An energy auditor will come into your home and assess its energy efficiency. The auditor will pinpoint areas of your home that use the most energy and offer solutions to lower your energy use and costs. Trained energy auditors know what to look for and can locate a variety of flaws that may be resulting in energy inefficiency, including inadequate insulation, construction flaws, and uneven heat distribution.

There are quicker and less costly measures that can be taken as well. One way to save money is to replace incandescent lights with fluorescents. This can result in a savings of more than 50% on your monthly lighting costs.

When it's time to replace old appliances, it's wise to spend a bit more for an energy-efficient model, and be sure that you are taking advantage of energy-saving settings already on your current refrigerator, dishwasher, washing machine, or dryer.

Windows provide another opportunity to cut your energy costs. Caulk old windows that might be leaky to prevent drafts, and choose double-paned windows if you're building an addition or replacing old windows.

Most areas of your home or apartment offer opportunities to save energy and money. The results are significant and are well worth the effort.

21. Which two main organizational schemes can be identified in this passage?

- a. hierarchical order and order by topic
- b. order by topic and cause and effect
- c. hierarchical order and chronological order
- d. chronological order and compare and contrast

22. Which of the following ideas is NOT included in this passage?

- a. You can reduce your \$130 monthly lighting costs to \$65 by using fluorescent bulbs instead of incandescent.
- b. Double-paned windows can cut energy costs.
- c. Your local energy company will send an energy auditor at your request.
- d. Some appliances have energy-saving settings.

23. Which of the following best expresses the main idea of this passage?

- a. There are many things a homeowner or renter can do to save energy and money.
- b. Hiring an energy auditor will save energy and money.
- c. Homeowners and renters don't know what they can do to save energy and money.
- d. Replacing windows and light bulbs are well worth the effort and cost.

24. According to the passage, which of the following would an energy auditor NOT do?

- a. Check for construction flaws.
- b. Look for problems with heat distribution.
- c. Offer solutions to lower your energy costs.
- d. Locate a variety of flaws that may result in energy inefficiency and fix them.

25. According to the passage, double-paned windows

- a. are energy efficient.
- b. should only be used as replacement windows.
- c. should only be used in new additions to homes.
- d. will lower your heating costs by 50%.

D. [Section header and passage not in the scan]

Page 6 of this quiz — the section header, a five-question reading passage (about Mesoamerican pyramids), and questions 26–29 — was not present in the uploaded file. Only question 30, the last question of the section, survives on the next page.

30. The passage tells us that Mesoamerican pyramids were

- a. Very strong in their architecture
- b. Took a lot of time to build
- c. Were not meant to survive very long
- d. Were made of moss

E. Read the following passage and choose the most appropriate answers for the questions that follow (2×5=10 marks)

During those barren winter months, with windows overlooking long-dead gardens, leafless trees, and lawns that seem to have an ashy look about them, nothing soothes the jangled nerves more than the vibrant green of plants surrounding the living spaces of one's home. People browse through greenhouses just to get a whiff of chlorophyll and to choose a plant or two to bring spring back into their winter gray lives.

Now there is even more of a need for "the green," in light of recent articles warning us of the hazards of chemicals that we, ourselves, introduce into our homes. Each time we bring clothes home from the cleaners, we release those chemicals into the closed-in air of our dwellings. Every cleanser brings its own assortment of fumes. Some of the chemicals are formaldehyde, chlorine, benzene, styrene, etc. Read the labels on many home products; the ingredients aren't even listed! During the winter, when those same windows are shut tight, we breathe in these chemicals — causing symptoms much like allergies. In fact, most people probably dismiss the effects of these chemicals simply as a flare up of a winter allergy or other.

The truth is that we are experiencing a syndrome that is called Multiple Chemical Sensitivity. Now, what has this got to do with green plants? Everything healthy! Research has been conducted with two types of plants that have actually removed much of these harmful chemicals from the air.

The two plants that seem to be the best bet for ridding one's home of such chemicals are ferns and palms. These plants release moisture as part of photosynthesis and, as they do, pull chemicals from the air into their leaves. Even NASA has conducted some greenhouse experiments for long-term space exploration. Within hours, their plants [palms] had removed almost all traces of formaldehyde in the room. Both species of plants are ancient, dating back more than a hundred million years. Another trait they share is that they both live long lives, 100 years or more. This we expect from trees, but ferns and palms are plants; plants that can grow to 65 feet in the proper setting! Even their individual leaves live on — one to two years [ferns] and one to nine years [palms]. Perhaps it is their primal qualities that have contributed to their ability to purify their environment.

31. What is the main idea of the passage?

- a. Our homes are full of contaminants.
- b. Our allergies are caused by chemicals found in the home.
- c. All plants release moisture in the home.
- d. Certain plants can purify the home of many harmful chemicals.

32. According to the passage, when a few harmful chemicals combine, they can

- a. cause us to experience allergies.
- b. cause a monumental task for homeowners.
- c. contribute to a syndrome called Multiple Chemical Sensitivity.
- d. contribute to photosynthesis in plants.

33. The passage indicates that research

- a. has only been conducted using specific plants.
- b. has only been conducted by NASA.
- c. has not identified the sources of these chemical impurities.
- d. has only benefited long-term space exploration.

34. The passage infers a relationship between the antiquity of ferns and palms and their ability to

- a. live long.
- b. purify the air.
- c. grow leaves that live long.
- d. react successfully in research experiments.

35. A good title for this passage is

- a. Research in the New Millennium.
- b. Home Dangers.
- c. Common Houseplants May Purify Your Home.
- d. NASA Experiment Finds the Cure.

General Instructions: please read very carefully:

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- Fill the correct answer as a bubble
- If two options are simultaneously chosen for one question, it will be marked wrong
- Read instructions very carefully and answer all questions
- Write your name and roll number
- No negative marking
- Use of mobile phones/internet not allowed

A. Carefully read the following questions on academic/professional communication and choose the most appropriate answer (1×10=10 marks)**1. Official meetings should ideally be convened for**

- a. Brainstorming on pertinent topics
- b. Creating official network within one's organization
- c. Finding carefully planned solution through consensus
- d. None of the above

2. Where agenda in official meetings is concerned, it should

- a. Be left entirely flexible and changeable
- b. Be circulated in advance
- c. Be kept confidential till meeting begins
- d. All of the above

3. Minutes of meetings are crucial because

- a. They help sticking to the time limit set for a meeting
- b. They provide a job for the minute taker
- c. They help avoid confusion once the meeting is over
- d. None of the above

4. During virtual meetings it is important to

- a. Keep presentations ready in advance
- b. Maintain composure in one's voice and tone
- c. Stick to the main point of discussion
- d. All of the above

5. A well-written resume should definitely contain

- a. Summary of one's childhood experiences
- b. Summary of one's most significant qualifications
- c. Summary of one's family income
- d. All of the above

6. While taking letters of reference for the resume, one should

- a. Never disturb referees by contacting them in advance
- b. Choose referees who have a fair and positive idea of one's credentials
- c. Choose referees who are next of kin for authenticity
- d. None of the above

7. Rogerian argument in meetings brings about

- a. A reconciliation between entirely opposing ideals
- b. A situation promoting the corporate rat race
- c. A platform for meaningful business negotiations
- d. A situation leading to creation of trade unions

8. According to the Harvard Negotiation Project, Principled Negotiation leads to

- a. Emotionally driven judgement on official issues
- b. Victory of one party over another
- c. Focus on one party's interest over another
- d. Possible options being created for mutual gain

9. To be a productive participant in a business meeting, one should be

- a. A vocal critic of all ideas presented
- b. An active social agent who exposes confidential issues
- c. A supportive and perceptive listener
- d. All of the above

10. An official memo or report is usually meant for

- a. Only the scientific advisers of an organization
- b. All office workers who regularly read newspapers
- c. Only the regular clients of an organization
- d. The manager and other non-expert readers in an organization

B. Read the following passage and choose the most appropriate answers for the questions that follow (2×5=10 marks)

On February 3, 1956, Autherine Lucy became the first African-American student to attend the University of Alabama, although the dean of women refused to allow Autherine to live in a university dormitory. White students rioted in protest of her admission, and the federal government had to assume command of the Alabama National Guard in order to protect her. Nonetheless, on her first day in class, Autherine bravely took a seat in the front row. She remembers being surprised that the professor of the class appeared not to notice she was even in class. Later, she would appreciate his seeming indifference, as he was one of only a few professors to speak out in favor of her right to attend the university.

For protection, Autherine was taken in and out of classroom buildings by the back door and driven from class to class by an assistant to the university president. The students continued to riot, and one day, the windshield of the car she was in was broken. University officials suspended her, saying it was for her own safety. When her attorney issued a statement in her name protesting her suspension, the university used it as grounds for expelling her for insubordination. Although she never finished her education at the University of Alabama, Autherine Lucy's courage was an inspiration to African-American students who followed her lead and desegregated universities all over the United States.

11. According to the passage, what did Autherine Lucy do on her first day at the University of Alabama?

- a. She moved into a dormitory.
- b. She sat in the front row of her class.
- c. She became terrified of the white rioters.
- d. She was befriended by an assistant to the university president.

12. Based on the information in the passage, which of the following best describes Autherine Lucy?

- a. quiet and shy
- b. courageous and determined
- c. clever and amusing
- d. overly dramatic

13. When she began classes at the university, Autherine Lucy expected to

- a. stand out from the other students.
- b. have the support of the university faculty.
- c. join an African-American organization for protection.
- d. be ridiculed by the professors.

14. Autherine Lucy never graduated from the University of Alabama because she

- a. moved to another state.
- b. transferred to another university.
- c. dropped out because of pressure from other students.
- d. was expelled for insubordination.

15. According to the passage, which of the following is true?

- a. The Alabama National Guard is normally under the command of the U.S. Army.
- b. In 1956, the only segregated university in the United States was in Alabama.
- c. Autherine Lucy was escorted to and from class by the university president's assistant.
- d. A few white students at the university were pleased that Autherine Lucy was a student there.

C. Read the following passage and choose the most appropriate answers for the questions that follow (2×5=10 marks)

The same energy-saving passage as Quiz 1, Section C, reused here as questions 16–20.

16. Which two main organizational schemes can be identified in this passage?

- a. hierarchical order and order by topic
- b. order by topic and cause and effect
- c. hierarchical order and chronological order
- d. chronological order and compare and contrast

17. Which of the following ideas is NOT included in this passage?

- a. You can reduce your \$130 monthly lighting costs to \$65 by using fluorescent bulbs instead of incandescent.
- b. Double-paned windows can cut energy costs.
- c. Your local energy company will send an energy auditor at your request.
- d. Some appliances have energy-saving settings.

18. Which of the following best expresses the main idea of this passage?

- a. There are many things a homeowner or renter can do to save energy and money.
- b. Hiring an energy auditor will save energy and money.
- c. Homeowners and renters don't know what they can do to save energy and money.
- d. Replacing windows and light bulbs are well worth the effort and cost.

19. According to the passage, which of the following would an energy auditor NOT do?

- a. Check for construction flaws.
- b. Look for problems with heat distribution.
- c. Offer solutions to lower your energy costs.
- d. Locate a variety of flaws that may result in energy inefficiency and fix them.

20. According to the passage, double-paned windows

- a. are energy efficient.
- b. should only be used as replacement windows.
- c. should only be used in new additions to homes.
- d. will lower your heating costs by 50%.

D. Vocabulary: Read the following sentences and try to choose the best definition for the italicized word by searching for context clues in the sentence (1×10=10 marks)

21. The designer window treatments in her house, installed 17 years ago, were *outmoded*.

- a. unnecessary
- b. pointless
- c. out-of-date
- d. worthless

22. Although the professor's lectures were regarded by many as so *wearisome* that they regularly put students to sleep, he ignored all criticism and refused to make any changes.

- a. modest
- b. unpleasant
- c. boring
- d. objectionable

23. The baseball player's *malice* toward the referee was revealed in his spiteful remarks to the media, which almost ruined the referee's career.

- a. vindictive
- b. crazy
- c. rude
- d. unpleasant

24. Although Zachary is much too inexperienced for the managerial position, he is a willful young man and *obdurately* refuses to withdraw his application.

- a. foolishly
- b. reluctantly
- c. constantly
- d. stubbornly

25. His neighbor's *superficial* remarks trivialized the property line dispute and infuriated Malcolm.

- a. enraged
- b. petty
- c. insulting
- d. misleading

26. When Katya refused to lie to her parents about where she was spending the night, she was completely *ostracized* by her usually loyal friends, who had never shunned her before.

- a. excluded
- b. hurt
- c. cheered
- d. helped

27. Her fashion sense was usually described as flamboyant, but on the night of the party, Tanya's outfit was uncharacteristically *modest*.

- a. impeccable
- b. showy
- c. sloppy
- d. unassuming

28. Mr. Powers was so *gullible* that he believed even the most outlandish excuses of his insincere employees.

- a. intelligent
- b. naive
- c. dishonest
- d. critical

29. You cannot become a certified teacher without completing the *prerequisite* student teaching assignment.

- a. required
- b. optional
- c. preferred
- d. advisable

30. Charles, aware of his susceptibility to gum disease, is *diligent* about flossing.

- a. uncomfortable
- b. excited
- c. thorough
- d. ambivalent

E. Find the most appropriate pair of words following the analogy given in the question (1×10=10 marks)

31. LAYER : TIER

- | | |
|----------------------|--------------------|
| a. section : segment | d. chapter : verse |
| b. dais : speaker | e. cotton : bale |
| c. curtain : stage | |

32. METROPOLITAN : URBAN

- | | |
|-----------------------|------------------------|
| a. bucolic : rural | d. autumn : harvest |
| b. sleepy : nocturnal | e. agrarian : generous |
| c. agricultural : cow | |

33. TEACHER : SCHOOL

- | | |
|----------------------|-----------------------|
| a. actor : role | d. judge : courthouse |
| b. mechanic : engine | e. author : book |
| c. jockey : horse | |

34. PERSIAN : CAT

- | | |
|--------------------------|--------------------|
| a. alligator : crocodile | d. rat : marsupial |
| b. zebra : reptile | e. fly : bee |
| c. parakeet : bird | |

35. RUN : JOG

- | | |
|-------------------|--------------------|
| a. trot : race | d. juggle : bounce |
| b. swim : dive | e. rain : drizzle |
| c. dance : ballet | |

36. SKEIN : YARN

- | | |
|--------------------|------------------|
| a. squeeze : lemon | d. tree : lumber |
| b. fire : coal | e. plow : acre |
| c. ream : paper | |

37. TAILOR : SUIT

- | | |
|----------------------|-----------------------|
| a. scheme : agent | d. mention : opinion |
| b. edit : manuscript | e. implode : building |
| c. revise : writer | |

38. CONDUCTOR : ORCHESTRA

- | | |
|---------------------|--------------------|
| a. jockey : mount | d. skipper : crew |
| b. thrasher : hay | e. painter : house |
| c. driver : tractor | |

39. JAUNDICE : LIVER

- | | |
|----------------------|------------------------|
| a. rash : skin | d. valentine : heart |
| b. dialysis : kidney | e. imagination : brain |
| c. smog : lung | |

40. COBBLER : SHOE

- a. jockey : horse
- b. contractor : building
- c. mason : stone

- d. cowboy : boot
- e. potter : paint



Trend analysis across both past papers

What this predicts about the format of your own quiz

Fixed structure, every time

- Both papers are exactly **5 sections, A-E**, bubble-sheet, no negative marking — matching your course's own announcement for Quiz 1.
- Both run to **50 marks** in the same shape: two 10-question, 1-mark concept sections (A, B), then one or more passages at 2 marks a question, then (in Quiz 2 only) a 10-question vocabulary-in-context section and a 10-question verbal-analogy section.
- Every passage-based question is phrased "**choose the most appropriate answer**", not "the correct answer" — several options are partly true, and the task is picking the best-supported one, not spotting a factual error.

The reading passages are reused wholesale

- The **energy-audit passage** appears twice, word-for-word, in these two papers (Quiz 1 §C and Quiz 2 §C) — the same passage, same five questions, just renumbered. Passages are drawn from a fixed bank and reused rather than freshly written per quiz.
- None of the three passages here (energy audits, Autherine Lucy, houseplants) relate to your course content (Achebe, Mansfield, Modernism) — they're generic reading-comprehension pieces, exactly matching your own course's promise of "**comprehension passages with questions**" drawn from general content, not the short stories.
- Because the passage bank repeats, it's worth treating **comprehension technique** (main idea, organisational scheme, what's NOT stated, inference) as the highest-leverage thing to drill — more so than memorising any one passage.

Two question families never touch the lecture slides

- **Vocabulary-in-context** (Quiz 2 §D): a sentence with one italicised word, four near-synonym options. This tests general vocabulary, not anything taught in class.
- **Verbal analogies** (Quiz 2 §E): classic A:B :: C:D pairs (LAYER:TIER, TEACHER:SCHOOL, etc.), again general-knowledge word relationships rather than course content.
- If your own quiz includes sections like these, no amount of lecture review helps — the only prep is practising analogy and vocabulary-in-context questions generally.

Quiz 2's concept sections point to content beyond what you've uploaded

- Quiz 1's concept sections (A, B) line up closely with your lecture slides: academic writing ethics, disagreeing with scholarship, AI in research, plagiarism, empathetic and firm communication.
- Quiz 2's concept section (A), by contrast, is about **meetings, agendas, minutes, resumes, referees, Rogerian argument, and the Harvard Negotiation Project's Principled Negotiation** — a business/professional-communication unit that doesn't appear anywhere in lectures L2–L8. That strongly suggests a **later lecture** (L9 or beyond) covers this, most likely closer to whichever week that quiz was given.
- If your upcoming quiz is an early one (like Quiz 1 here), the L2–L8 material is squarely on-topic. If it's a later quiz, expect a meetings/negotiation/resume unit you haven't seen yet — worth asking your instructor or checking for a lecture you haven't uploaded.

Bottom line for your prep: keep drilling the lecture-content MCQs in the main guide for sections A/B-style questions; separately practice general reading comprehension, vocabulary-in-context, and analogies, since those are guaranteed formats that don't come from the slides at all.